

The Impact of Intermittent Fasting on Cognitive Function
Does intermittent fasting improve cognitive function in healthy adults?

#	Name	Type	Year	Authors	Journal	Volume	Summary
1	Acute effects of fasting on cognitive performance: A systematic review and meta-analysis	Journal Article	2025	Christoph Bamberg; David Moreau	<i>Psychological Bulletin</i>	—	
2	Effects of 15:9 time-restricted eating on cognitive function and anthropometric parameters among the elderly with mild cognitive impairment: an assessor-blinded, pilot randomized controlled trial	Journal Article	2025	Jun Wang; Fang Wang; Meihong Shi; Hongxiu Chen; Qingquan Liu; Li Liu; Xueqiong Xu; Chunxia He; Lisheng Xu; Xiuying Hu	<i>BMC Geriatrics</i>	36	
3	Association between Time Restricted Feeding and Cognitive Status in Older Italian Adults	Journal Article	2021	W. Currenti; J. Godos; Sabrina Castellano; Giuseppe Caruso; R. Ferri; F. Caraci; Giuseppe Grosso; F. Galvano	<i>Nutrients</i>	13	

Summary

1. Across these three studies, researchers examine the relationship between **fasting, time-restricted eating, and cognitive function** in both healthy adults and older populations.
2. The 2025 systematic review evaluates the **acute cognitive effects of fasting**, addressing whether short-term food deprivation compromises mental performance.
3. The 2025 randomized controlled trial investigates whether **12 weeks of 15:9 time-restricted eating** may affect cognition and anthropometric outcomes in older adults with mild cognitive impairment.
4. The 2021 Italian study explores the association between **feeding-time patterns and cognitive status**, highlighting meal timing as a potentially modifiable lifestyle factor.
5. Collectively, the research suggests that the relationship between fasting/meal timing and cognition is an important area of investigation, with evidence spanning **immediate cognitive effects, longer-term interventions, and observational associations**.

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time-restricted eating and cognitive performance in health...15.1M

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Evidence is mixed on whether intermittent fasting improves cognition in healthy adults; benefits appear limited to older or at-risk populations.

Does intermittent fasting improve cognitive function in healthy adults?N = 16

Yes13%

Possibly25%

Mixed31%

No31%

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Evidence Claims for Cognitive Effects of Intermittent Fasting

Evidence Strength	Claim
Strong	A meta-analysis of 3,484 healthy adults found no meaningful cognitive difference between fasted and satiated states (g = 0.02) BAMBERG 2025
Moderate	An 8-week RCT in 40 cognitively intact older adults with insulin resistance found 5:2 intermittent fasting improved executive function and memory beyond a healthy diet alone KAPOGIANNIS 2024
Moderate	A 12-week 15:9 TRE trial in 46 older adults with mild cognitive impairment improved MoCA total scores and recognition memory WANG 2025
Moderate	A cross-sectional study of 883 Italian older adults found time-restricted feeding was associated with lower odds of cognitive impairment (OR = 0.28) CURRENTI 2021